

Working in IDLE

IDLE is a free application that is installed with Python. Designed for beginners, it includes a basic text editor that allows the user to write and edit Python code. It has two different windows – the editor window, which can be used to write and save programs, and the shell window, which runs Python instructions immediately. The shell window gives an immediate response, which makes it ideal for testing and exploring.

► Testing the code

IDLE works in three easy steps: write the code, save it, and then run it. This program will ask the user a question and will then check to see if the answer is correct.

The name of the file is shown here.

Editor window

```
def check_guess (guess, answer):
    if guess == answer:
        print('Correct answer')
    print ('Guess the Animal!')
    guess1 = input ('Which is the largest animal? ')
    check_guess(guess1, 'blue whale')
```

Programs are saved and run from the menu bar.

The code is entered in the editor window.

The output for the program appears in the shell window.

```
Guess the Animal!
Which is the largest animal? blue whale
Correct answer
>>>
```

Users type the answer in the shell window

Shell window

Python in action

A general-purpose programming language, Python has various applications in the fields of business, medicine, science, and media. It is used to test microchips, power apps, build video games, and write real-world programs.



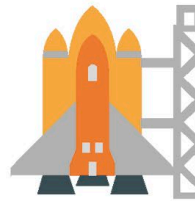
Web development

Widely used on the internet, Python is often used as a support language by software developers and for build control and testing.



Business

Python's special libraries and easily readable syntax make it a suitable coding language for customizing larger applications. It can be used by banks to keep track of transactions, and by stores to set prices for their products.



Space

Software engineers have used Python to create tools for NASA's Mission Control Centre. These tools help the crew prepare for and monitor the progress of each mission.



Game development

Python has various modules, libraries, and platforms that support computer game development. PySox is a 3D game engine that supports Python, and PyGame provides functionality and a library for game development.



Scientific computing

Python is used for scientific computing, and it even has some libraries dedicated to specific areas of science. It can also be used to program robots to perform tricky operations.